

AI Prompt Playbook

Vol. 2: Systems & Automation

25 prompts for turning AI into repeatable systems — not just one-off tasks

Set it up once. Reuse it every week.

How this is different from Vol. 1

Vol. 1 (The Small Business AI Prompt Playbook) covers one-off tasks — draft this email, write that job post. Vol. 2 is about the next level: prompts that become *systems* you set up once and reuse on a schedule — a weekly ops review, a customer win-back sequence, a recurring competitive scan. You don't need Vol. 1 to use this book; the two are companions, not a strict sequence.

Every prompt works with any modern AI chat assistant (Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini, or similar). Replace anything in [BRACKETS] with your own details. A companion spreadsheet (Automation-ROI-Tracker.xlsx) is included — use it to log which of these you've turned into a recurring habit, how often they run, and the compounding time saved.

What's inside

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Build Your AI Systems

1. Persistent Assistant Persona Builder

I want to build a reusable AI assistant for [RECURRING JOB, e.g. 'drafting my weekly investor update']. Write a persistent system/custom-instructions prompt (for a Custom GPT, Claude Project, or similar) that includes: the assistant's exact role and scope, 3-5 things it should always ask for before starting if not provided, the output format it should default to, and 2-3 explicit things it should NOT do (e.g. invent numbers, guess at facts it wasn't given). Write it as instructions I can paste once and reuse indefinitely.

When to use it: The first time you notice you're typing a similar long prompt more than twice — build the system once instead of retyping it.

Pro tip: Save the finished persona as a Custom GPT or Claude Project, not just a saved prompt in a notes app — that's what makes it a system instead of a one-off.

2. Recurring Weekly Ops Review Generator

Every week I want to feed you the same categories of raw information and get the same structured review back. Build me a reusable template prompt that takes: [LIST YOUR WEEKLY INPUTS, e.g. sales numbers, support ticket count, cash balance, top customer complaint] and always outputs: a 3-sentence headline summary, one thing that improved, one thing that got worse, and one recommended action for next week. Write the reusable template, not this week's answer.

When to use it: Setting up any recurring review rhythm (weekly/monthly) you plan to repeat, not a single one-time report.

Pro tip: Keep the exact same input categories every week even when a number is zero or unchanged — a system only shows trends if the shape never changes.

3. Knowledge Base Q&A; Builder From Your Docs

Here is a set of internal documents/policies: [PASTE OR LIST YOUR DOCS]. Build a structured Q&A; knowledge base from them: extract every question a new employee or customer would plausibly ask, answer each strictly from what the documents say (mark anything you're inferring rather than quoting), and flag any obvious gap where a likely question has no answer in the source material at all.

When to use it: Turning scattered docs (policies, SOPs, old emails) into one searchable reference before onboarding a new hire or launching a help center.

Pro tip: Re-run this every time a policy changes — a knowledge base that silently goes stale is worse than no knowledge base, since people trust it.

4. Meeting-to-Destination Router

Here are raw notes from today's meeting: [PASTE NOTES]. Instead of one action list, sort every item into exactly one destination: 'Slack a teammate now', 'Add to project tracker', 'Needs a calendar follow-up', 'Customer-facing — needs a reply', or 'Just a decision, no action needed'. For each item, write it in the exact format ready to paste into that destination (e.g. a Slack message, a tracker ticket title + description).

When to use it: After any meeting where action items need to land in different tools/people, not just one shared list.

Pro tip: This is the one prompt in this pack worth wiring into an actual automation (Zapier/Make) once you've validated the routing logic manually a few times.

5. Standard Response Library Builder

Here are the [N] messages/questions we get most often from [CUSTOMERS/PROSPECTS/TEAM]: [PASTE EXAMPLES]. Build a library of reusable response snippets: group similar requests, write one polished, fill-in-the-blank response per group, and name each snippet clearly so it's easy to find later (e.g. 'Pricing Objection — Enterprise', 'Refund Request — Standard').

When to use it: Building your first canned-response library, or cleaning one up that's grown messy over time.

Pro tip: Store these in your actual help desk/CRM's snippet feature, not a separate doc — a library nobody can find while typing a live reply doesn't get used.

Customer Lifecycle Automation

1. Lapsed Customer Win-Back Sequence

We have customers who haven't purchased/used [PRODUCT/SERVICE] in [TIMEFRAME, e.g. '90 days']. Write a 3-email win-back sequence: email 1 (a genuine check-in, no pitch), email 2 (address the most likely reason people in this situation drift away: [YOUR BEST GUESS OR KNOWN REASON]), email 3 (a specific, time-bound incentive to come back: [YOUR OFFER]). Keep the tone like a person who noticed they left, not an automated blast.

When to use it: Any time you have a list of customers who've gone quiet and a way to email them.

Pro tip: Segment by the actual reason they likely left if you can (price, a bad experience, no longer needed) — a single generic sequence converts worse than a targeted one.

2. New Customer Onboarding Drip

Someone just bought [PRODUCT/SERVICE]. Write a 4-email onboarding drip sent over their first 2 weeks: email 1 (immediate — how to get the first quick win in under 10 minutes), email 2 (day 3 — the single most-missed feature/step), email 3 (day 7 — a check-in asking if they're stuck, with a specific way to get help), email 4 (day 14 — ask for a review/testimonial only if they've shown signs of actually using it).

When to use it: Setting up (or fixing) the automated sequence a customer receives right after purchase.

Pro tip: Only ask for a review in email 4 if you have any usage signal at all (an open, a login, a reply) — asking a silent non-user for a testimonial reads as tone-deaf.

3. NPS / Feedback Theme Extractor

Here are [N] raw customer feedback responses (survey answers, reviews, or support quotes): [PASTE RESPONSES]. Group them into themes, and for each theme report: how many people mentioned it, 1-2 representative quotes, and whether it's a Positive, Negative, or Feature Request. Rank themes by frequency, highest first. Do not soften negative themes to sound nicer than they are.

When to use it: After any survey close, or quarterly if you collect reviews continuously.

Pro tip: Track theme frequency over time in a simple log — a single snapshot tells you what's wrong today, a trend tells you if it's getting better or worse.

4. Churn Risk Signal Scanner

Here are recent support tickets/usage notes for a set of customers: [PASTE NOTES, ONE SECTION PER CUSTOMER]. For each customer, flag a churn risk level (Low/Medium/High) based only on concrete signals in the text (complaints about value, mentions of a competitor, declining usage, unresolved issues, contract questions) — not vibes. List the specific signal(s) that drove each rating so a human can verify it, not just trust the label.

When to use it: *Monthly account-health review, especially once you have more accounts than you can track from memory.*

Pro tip: *Always have a human review High-risk flags before acting — this prompt surfaces candidates for outreach, it doesn't replace the judgment call.*

5. Referral Ask Email Generator

Write a referral-request email for a customer who has shown a specific positive signal: [DESCRIBE THE SIGNAL, e.g. 'left a 5-star review', 'renewed early', 'said something great in a support ticket']. Reference that specific signal honestly (don't fabricate detail), make the ask concrete and low-effort (name exactly what a good referral looks like), and offer a real, specific incentive: [YOUR INCENTIVE, or 'none' if you don't want to offer one].

When to use it: *Right after a customer shows a genuine positive signal — referral asks convert far better tied to a real moment than sent as a cold blast.*

Pro tip: *Never send this to a customer with an open complaint or unresolved ticket — timing it wrong turns a goodwill ask into an awkward one.*

Competitive & Market Intelligence

1. Competitor Website Teardown

Here is the homepage/pricing page copy from a competitor: [PASTE OR SUMMARIZE THE PAGE]. Break down: their core value proposition in one sentence, who they appear to be targeting, their pricing structure and what it implies about their target customer size, and 2-3 specific claims or features they emphasize that we don't currently mention anywhere in our own materials.

When to use it: Before a pricing change, a new competitor entering your space, or a quarterly positioning check.

Pro tip: Do this for 2-3 competitors at once and compare the outputs side by side — a single teardown tells you about them, a comparison tells you about the gap.

2. Pricing Page Comparison Matrix

Here are the pricing tiers/features for us and [N] competitors: [PASTE EACH COMPANY'S TIERS AND WHAT'S INCLUDED]. Build a comparison table: rows are features, columns are companies, cells show what's included at what tier. Then write 3 sentences on where we're priced high or low for what we include, based only on what's in the table — not general pricing advice.

When to use it: Before a pricing review, or when a prospect asks 'why do you cost more/less than X'.

Pro tip: Re-pull competitor pricing fresh each time — pasting an old comparison and just re-analyzing it will miss changes they've quietly made.

3. Industry News Digest Summarizer

Here are [N] articles/posts from this week about [YOUR INDUSTRY/NICHE]: [PASTE HEADLINES + LINKS OR TEXT]. Summarize into a digest: 3-5 bullet points on what actually changed or matters, one sentence on why each one is relevant to a business like ours specifically, and skip anything that's just generic industry noise with no real implication for us.

When to use it: Weekly or biweekly, once you've built a habit of collecting a handful of industry sources.

Pro tip: Paste the actual article text when you can, not just headlines — headline-only summaries tend to hallucinate the 'why it matters' part.

4. Customer Review Gap-Mining

Here are public reviews of a competitor's product: [PASTE REVIEWS, IDEALLY A MIX OF POSITIVE AND NEGATIVE]. Extract: the 3 most common complaints (these are unmet needs a competing product could win on), the 3 most common praises (these are the bar you need to match, not just beat), and any complaint that shows up in a product like ours too, if you know our own reviews: [OPTIONAL: PASTE OUR OWN REVIEW COMPLAINTS FOR COMPARISON].

When to use it: *Scoping a new feature, or deciding what to emphasize in marketing against a specific competitor.*

Pro tip: *Weight recent reviews more than old ones — a complaint from 2 years ago may already be fixed and isn't a real gap anymore.*

5. Positioning Statement Stress-Test

Here is our current positioning statement / one-line pitch: [PASTE IT]. Play the role of a skeptical prospect who has 3 other options in this market. Ask the 3 hardest questions this statement leaves unanswered, then rewrite the statement to address the single biggest gap without making it longer than the original.

When to use it: *Whenever the pitch feels stale, before a fundraiser/pitch, or after losing a deal to a specific competitor for a positioning reason.*

Pro tip: *Do this quarterly even when nothing feels wrong — positioning drifts quietly as a market shifts, and you rarely notice from the inside.*

Reporting & Ops Rhythm

1. Weekly KPI Digest From Raw Numbers

Here are this week's raw numbers: [PASTE METRICS, e.g. revenue, new customers, churn, support tickets, ad spend]. Compare against last week's numbers: [PASTE PRIOR WEEK]. Write a digest: 3 headline bullet points on what moved and by how much (as a percentage, not just raw numbers), one metric that needs attention this week and why, and skip any metric that moved less than 5% — that's noise, not signal, at this level of detail.

When to use it: Every week, once you have at least 2 weeks of comparable numbers to work from.

Pro tip: Keep the exact same metric list every week even during a slow week — the value of this system is in the comparison, and comparisons need consistent inputs.

2. Investor / Board One-Pager Generator

Here is this period's performance data: [PASTE KEY NUMBERS] and context: [ANY NOTABLE WINS, RISKS, OR DECISIONS NEEDED]. Write a one-page update: headline number first, 3 bullets on progress, 1-2 bullets on real risks (not sandbagged optimism), and one specific ask if you need anything from the reader (an intro, a decision, feedback). Plain language, no jargon, no spin.

When to use it: Monthly or quarterly investor/board/advisor updates.

Pro tip: Write the risks section yourself first, unedited, before running this prompt — it's tempting to let AI phrase around a real problem instead of stating it.

3. Inventory Reorder Point Calculator

Here is my situation for [PRODUCT/SKU]: average daily sales of [X units], supplier lead time of [Y days], and I want a safety buffer of [Z days] of extra stock in case of delays or a sales spike. Calculate: the reorder point (units on hand at which I should place a new order), and show the exact formula used so I can recalculate it myself next time my numbers change.

When to use it: Setting reorder points for the first time, or any time lead times or sales pace changes meaningfully.

Pro tip: Recalculate this every quarter, not once and forget it — a reorder point based on last year's sales pace will leave you either overstocked or stocked out.

4. Task Prioritization Matrix

Here is my task list for this week: [PASTE TASKS]. Sort every task into an Eisenhower matrix: Urgent+Important (do first), Important+Not Urgent (schedule a specific time), Urgent+Not Important (delegate if possible, name who to), Neither (candidate to drop). For anything you're unsure how to classify, ask one clarifying question instead of guessing.

When to use it: Monday morning planning, or any time the task list feels unmanageable.

Pro tip: Be honest about what's actually urgent vs. what just feels urgent because it's loud (a Slack ping) — the matrix only works if the inputs are accurate.

5. Anomaly Flag in Weekly Numbers

Here are my weekly numbers for the last [N] weeks: [PASTE A SIMPLE TABLE OF WEEK + METRIC VALUES]. Identify any week where a metric moved meaningfully outside its normal pattern (not just up or down, but outside the range the other weeks establish). For each anomaly found, state which week, which metric, and by how much it deviated from the trend — don't speculate on the cause unless I've given you context to work from.

When to use it: Monthly, once you have at least 6-8 weeks of the same metrics logged consistently.

Pro tip: This catches things a simple week-over-week comparison misses — a slow 8-week decline, for example, where no single week looks alarming on its own.

Delegation & Team Enablement

1. Role Handoff Document Writer

I'm handing off [RESPONSIBILITY/PROJECT] to [PERSON/ROLE]. Here's how I currently handle it, roughly: [DESCRIBE WHAT YOU DO]. Write a handoff document: what this responsibility actually covers (and explicitly what it does NOT cover, to prevent scope confusion), the recurring cadence if any, who to contact for what, and the 2-3 judgment calls that come up most often with a note on how you've been deciding them.

When to use it: *Delegating a responsibility for the first time, or when someone leaves and knowledge needs to transfer before they go.*

Pro tip: *Have the new owner read it back to you in their own words before you consider the handoff done — a document that makes sense to you may not to them.*

2. Expert-to-Training-Script Converter

Here is a transcript or rough recording of an expert explaining how to [TASK/PROCESS]: [PASTE TRANSCRIPT]. Convert it into a clean training script: numbered steps in the order a learner should follow them (not necessarily the order the expert mentioned them), plain language replacing any jargon the expert used without explaining, and a short 'common mistake' callout anywhere the expert mentioned something people tend to get wrong.

When to use it: *Turning a subject-matter expert's knowledge into something repeatable that doesn't depend on them being available to explain it live every time.*

Pro tip: *Record the expert explaining it as if to a brand-new hire, not as if to a peer — that framing naturally surfaces the steps they'd otherwise skip as 'obvious'.*

3. Decision Log Entry Writer

We just made this decision: [DESCRIBE THE DECISION]. Here's the context: [WHY IT CAME UP, WHAT OPTIONS WERE CONSIDERED]. Write a decision log entry: the decision in one sentence, the 2-3 alternatives considered and why they weren't chosen, who made the call, and one specific condition under which this decision should be revisited.

When to use it: *Any decision you'd hate to re-debate from scratch in 6 months because nobody remembers why you chose what you chose.*

Pro tip: *The 'when to revisit' field is the one people skip and the one that matters most — a decision without a revisit trigger tends to just quietly become permanent.*

4. Goal-to-Agenda Meeting Builder

This meeting needs to accomplish: [THE SPECIFIC OUTCOME YOU NEED, e.g. 'decide which of 2 vendors to use']. Attendees: [LIST]. Build an agenda that works backward from that outcome: what needs to be presented, what needs to be decided and by whom, and a hard time budget per section that adds up to [MEETING LENGTH]. Flag if the outcome realistically needs more time than that.

When to use it: Any meeting you're calling, especially recurring ones that have drifted from having a clear purpose.

Pro tip: If you can't state the specific outcome in one sentence before building the agenda, that's the real problem — no agenda template fixes an unclear purpose.

5. Peer Feedback Request Template

I want honest feedback from [PEER/TEAM] on [SPECIFIC WORK OR DECISION, not 'how am I doing' in general]. Write a short request message that asks 2-3 specific questions instead of an open-ended 'any thoughts?', makes it easy to say something critical without it feeling confrontational, and gives a clear deadline so it doesn't sit unanswered.

When to use it: Any time you want feedback that's actually useful rather than a polite 'looks good'.

Pro tip: Specific questions get specific answers — 'what's confusing about this' beats 'what do you think' almost every time.

Want this tailored to your business?

These prompts are deliberately generic templates so they work across industries. If you want a custom set built specifically around your business, your voice, and your actual recurring systems, reach out — contact details are on the product page you downloaded this from.

More From Ledger & Loop Digital

Look for these on the same store page you downloaded this from.

The Small Business AI Prompt Playbook (Vol. 1) — \$17

25 ready-to-use, one-off prompts for marketing, support, finance, hiring & sales, plus an ROI tracker.

The Freelancer Quarterly Tax & Expense Tracker (2026 Edition) — \$19

2026 quarterly deadlines, a self-employment tax calculator with a worked example, all 17 Schedule C expense categories, and a live tax-estimator spreadsheet.

The Freelancer Invoice & Late-Payment Toolkit — \$17

A ready-to-copy 4-stage reminder email sequence, how to choose payment terms and set an enforceable late fee, and a spreadsheet that auto-flags overdue invoices.

The Freelancer Money Bundle (Tax Tracker + Invoice Toolkit) — \$29

Both freelancer toolkits above together, for less than buying them separately.